The idea of an Indian bank managed by Indians began to germinate in Sorabji's mind. This seed flung upon the fertile soil of his imagination would yield an unbelievably rich crop, when the Central Bank of India would succeed beyond all expectations. But at that time, given the revolutionary nature of Sorabji's thoughts, he must have had his doubts, considering the fact that he was challenging the very system he found himself in. What Sorabji had in mind was 'nothing less than a challenge of the system then structured, and the destruction of the assumption on which it was founded.'[5] Sorabji pondered the idea as to why Indians should not establish banks of their own not only in self-vindication but also in the national interest. During this difficult period, he found great sympathy, understanding, and encouragement from his wife Sakerbai who was a constant source of strength and supported him through many crises.

Sorabji's frustration with the prejudice against Indians was reinforced when he heard Stringfellow tell a delegation of merchants from Ahmedabad that no Indian was competent to manage a branch of the bank there. Wherever he turned, opinion, sentiment, and convention seemed uniformly hostile: Sorabji must have been infuriated with people invoking the trite colonialist litany of insufficiency of banking talent in India. More frustration followed when his impeccable credentials could not induce the Chairman of the Bombay Merchants' Bank to offer him the post of a Manager. Sorabji confided in Kalianji Vardhman Jetsey, a leading cotton merchant of Bombay who had become a close friend after their initial acquaintance at the bank. In him, Sorabji found a sympathetic and capable confidant who shared his ideas on most subjects. He narrated his experiences where he had been discriminated against and how nothing could induce the foreigners to recognize the competence of Indians. Sorabji also pointed out the role of Indian banks in national progress and stressed the need to challenge the prevailing system. He told Kalianji that all he needed to start a new bank was capital of about ₹10-20 lakhs. Without much persuasion Kalianji agreed to support him in finding the necessary capital. The unsatisfactory manner in which the Bank of India had responded to his proposals for credit must also have strengthened his resolve to support Sorabji's scheme.

In those days the idea of swadeshi was gaining strength and after some initial hesitation it was applied to the world of banking. By the turn of the